Persona Design



Problem 4 | Voice AI Hackathon 2.0 | October 2026

Problem Statement

Problem 4 of 6 | Persona Design

The problem today

- The Voice Bot talks to every seller in one voice and one style, and keeps it for the whole call.
- Sellers differ in pace, patience, language and how they object.
- A seller who gets irritated, confused or rushed mid-call still gets the same delivery.

The challenge

- Before each call, build the Voice Bot persona that fits that seller, from the seller's own data.
- Then adapt it live as the call unfolds.
- Goal of this call: a meeting with an IndiaMART executive.

What we build

1 Seller data
profile, plan, turnover, categories, engagement, past calls

2 Persona generator
voice, language, tone, pace per seller

3 Conversation plan
opening, hook, objections, guardrails

4 Past-call evidence
what works for which seller type

5 Live adaptation
rush, confusion, frustration, language switch

6 Voice demo on Sarvam
contrasting sellers, live mid-call switch

The Gap, and How We Solve It

Today's VANI: one script for everyone

- Same voice, pace and opening for every seller; the opening rests on an enquiry count and the city.
- Seller details it could use are not in the call: similar sellers, live buy-lead data, order value, catalogue quality, plan, handler.
- 12 recurring objections (busy, price, 'why a meeting', 'executive came before') get generic replies.
- A rushed, confused or irritated seller gets the same delivery; baseline meeting rate about 22% over 270,000 answered calls.

Our approach: persona per seller, adapted live

Before the call

Build a seller context from 50+ data points, then design the persona and the call plan, each choice tied to the seller's data.

During the call

A live signal tool reads each seller turn (rushed, confused, frustrated, interested, language switch, opt-out) and changes how VANI speaks, same turn.

After the call

Review the call, log what worked, update what we learn for the next seller.

Data VANI did not use before, and we now supply to the agent

Similar sellers (same size, same category)	Live buy-lead data and order values	Category and product value	Catalogue quality score	Plan and credit usage
Enquiry trend	Top categories by active products	Assigned executive (handler)	City, GST state, language	Past-call mood and objections

Seller Factors, Personas, Hooks

Main seller factors

- Plan: free (NSD) or paid (CSD)
- Size by turnover: small, medium, medium-high, high
- Order value (AOV) tier vs the category
- Location, GST state, regional language
- Catalogue strength (quality score, photo and price gaps)
- Buy-lead usage: lapsed, unused, active; lead quality
- Enquiry flow: rising, flat, falling
- Similar sellers: same size, same category
- Past-call mood: rushed, frustrated, confused
- Open grievance, recent executive contact, call fatigue
- Handler (assigned executive)

7 personas (starting points)

P0 Default
natural Hinglish, direct; the control

P1 Numbers-first advisor
one concrete number, confident

P2 Warm local helper
regional language, simple words, help framing

P3 Patient guide
short phrases, checks understanding

P4 Brief and busy-friendly
one short sentence, callback at once

P5 Respectful problem-solver
acknowledges the problem first

P6 Senior advisor
business-like, English-led, never pushy

8 hooks (reason to meet)

Money lead
a live or recent order with its value

Profile gap
photos and prices missing

Category demand
buy requirements in the category

Unused credits
paid, but leads not used

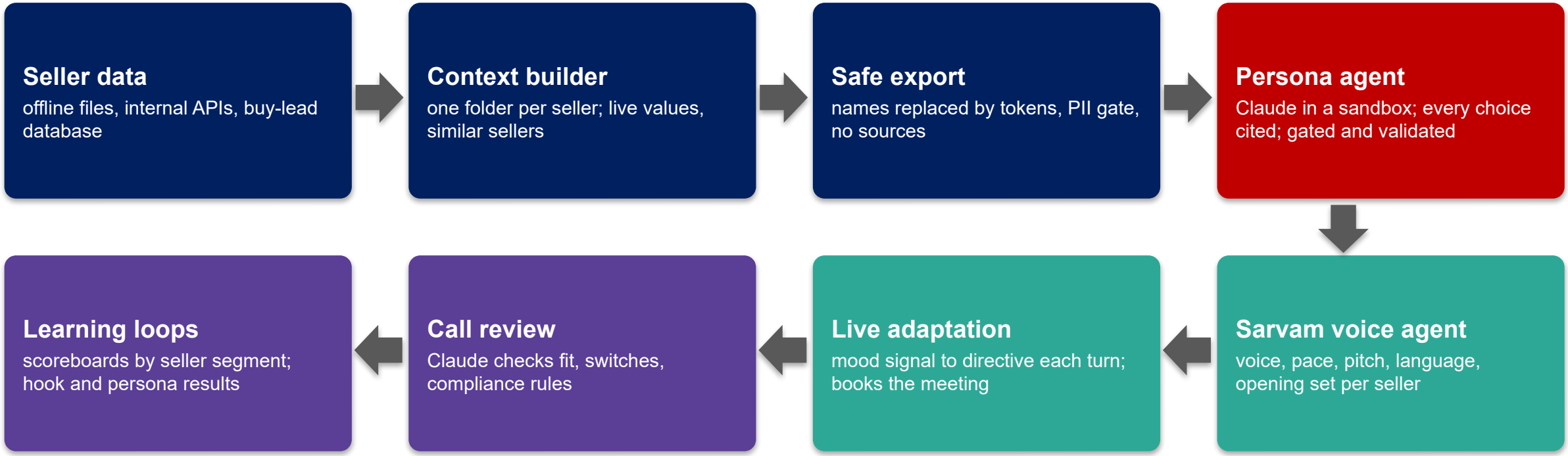
Lead quality fix
set filters for the right buyers

Enquiry drop
enquiries fell vs last quarter

Peer usage
same-size sellers buy leads

Resolve grievance
acknowledge the complaint first

Our Architecture



Safety rails: never says AI, bot or manager; numbers only from verified facts; names stay as tokens in the sandbox and are filled in only for the call; no plan or price on the call; compliance rules on every call; humans approve persona library changes.

Future Goals

Now: meeting arrangement

- Right persona and hook for each seller to get the executive meeting.
- Live adaptation when the seller is rushed, confused or irritated.
- Demo: contrasting sellers, regional languages, a live mid-call switch.

Next: seller enrichment

- Catalogue improvement calls: missing photos, prices, categories.
- Suggestions from the seller's top categories and similar sellers.
- A hook on the seller's top category.
- Profile completion with the seller on the call.

Later: higher packages

- Selling higher packages using credit usage, lead quality and peer proof.
- Renewal and upsell calls with the same persona engine.
- Learn from real calls: persona and hook scoreboards by seller segment.
- More languages and voices, production telephony at scale.

Demo: Live Calls

Same engine, contrasting sellers, at least one live mid-call switch

▶ **video to be added**
Demo call 1

A free seller in a regional-language region: warm local persona, profile-gap hook, language follows the seller.

▶ **video to be added**
Demo call 2

A paying seller with buy-lead data: numbers-first persona, credit-usage or money-lead hook; seller says 'busy', VANI shortens and offers a callback.

▶ **video to be added**
Demo call 3

A high-turnover seller: senior persona, English start; seller asks about the handler, VANI names the executive and books the meeting.

Planned scenarios; videos to be added. Each demo shows the persona spec with its reasons and the switch log: signal detected, change made, reason.

Thank You!

